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Independent compilation of publicly available news reporting. Not a US government, DoD or Intelligence Community product.

Items marked *pre-window onset* began shortly before the window opened but were reported within it. Text marked **Assessment** is analytic judgment using ICD 203 estimative language. Everything else is reporting attributed to the cited source.

// BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

- **CENTCOM:** AP confirms the US told allies to prepare for renewed strikes on Iran after the midterms, with a carrier and Marine build-up under way. With about 90% counted, Netanyahu's bloc has 53 seats to Eisenkot's 48 and Arab parties have a record 19; the elections chief asked Shin Bet to examine foreign-funding claims. Iran's Guards say three more tankers hit mines near Hormuz. [29][23][26][33]
- **EUCOM:** Russia says it downed 1,214 Ukrainian drones overnight, 613 of them heading for Moscow, and several Moscow airports closed. The Oleshky ceasefire has held for 54 hours. Zelensky expects three-way talks in Abu Dhabi between 6 and 10 November. [40][41][45][48]
- **AFRICOM:** Ethiopia's Abiy announced delivery of 12 Russian Su-35 fighters and plans for S-400 air defences at the Moscow summit. UN investigators say October has seen the most drone attacks on Sudanese civilians of the war. Tanzania banned memorials on today's anniversary of the 2025 election violence. [1][11][13]
- **INDOPACOM:** North Korea fired about 10 to 12 short-range ballistic missiles from Wonsan and appears to have tested its border loudspeakers. China publicly blamed Manila for its downgraded ASEAN defence attendance. Taiwan says 53 Chinese ships are deployed at once from southern Japan to the Philippines. [57][59][60][62][68]
- **NORTHCOM:** Judge Carter refused DOJ's bid to set aside about 20,000 California ballots and appointed no special master, and DOJ is appealing. The FEC's filing system is back after about 41 hours offline. Mexico's navy killed a US-indicted Guasave Cartel leader. [78][80][82]

- **SOUTHCOM:** The UN again condemned the US embargo on Cuba, but by 130 to 17, its weakest support since 1995. Flávio Bolsonaro landed in Miami on a US visa. Haiti pushed its elections to July 2027 as El Salvador pledged more than 2,000 troops. [91][92][95][98][99]

// AFRICOM

ETHIOPIA / RUSSIA: Abiy says 12 Su-35 fighters delivered, S-400 purchase planned

Abiy Ahmed posted during the Moscow summit that Ethiopia had received "the first twelve Su-35" fighters a year ahead of schedule, and said Ethiopia plans to acquire four S-400 air defence batteries. [1][2] Ethiopian state media said Abiy and Putin discussed nuclear energy, health and trade. [3] The US Embassy says fighting in Tigray is concentrated outside Mekelle and near the Eritrean border, and flights to Axum and Shire remain suspended. [4]

Assessment: A visible jump in Ethiopian air power, announced in Moscow, likely raises the risk of escalation with Eritrea, with which Ethiopia cut ties in early October.

RUSSIA / AFRICA: Putin pitches Russia as a better partner than the West; Day Two outcomes pending

Putin told delegations from 48 countries that the West exploits Africa's resources and that Western debt terms hold back development. [5] The Kremlin says Day Two includes signing 33 documents, a summit declaration, an AI declaration and a 2027-2029 action plan, plus meetings with Ruto, Mnangagwa and Sudan's Burhan. [6] Burhan's delegation includes his intelligence chief and the head of Sudan's defence industries. [7] Al Jazeera lists Burkina Faso's Traoré and Niger's Tiani as expected. [8] No outcome documents had been published by the cutoff.

Assessment: The Putin-Burhan meeting is the most likely venue for security or naval-base announcements.

AFRICA / RUSSIA: Rosatom markets floating nuclear plants; Togo signs MoU

Rosatom's chief said it is in "advanced discussions" with Egypt, Togo, Namibia and Tanzania on 100 MW floating nuclear units, refuelled and serviced in Russia. [9] Togo signed a memorandum with Rosatom to assess nuclear options. [10]

Assessment: These are framework steps, not contracts, but floating units would create long-term Russian service ties in coastal states.

SUDAN: UN investigators record the war's worst month for drone attacks on civilians

The UN Fact-Finding Mission says October has seen the most drone attacks on civilians of the war. It reports army security cells in El Obeid have arrested "thousands" and that the central prison holds about 2,000 people against a capacity of 450. It is also investigating reported Egyptian airstrikes that killed at least 72 gold miners near the border, and found an RSF supply network involving actors in Chad, Puntland, Libya and the UAE. [11] A party to the conflict now puts the 26 Oct Nyala market toll above 100, against the 21 reported earlier. [12]

Assessment: The findings put army abuses on record alongside the RSF's. If confirmed, the Egyptian strikes would mean a neighbouring state striking directly inside Sudan.

TANZANIA: Memorials banned on anniversary of 2025 election violence

Police warned against "criminal" mobilisation on 29 Oct despite a presidential commission recommending a memorial; the Catholic Church called for nationwide masses and CHADEMA declared a week of mourning. [13]

The US Embassy warned of roadblocks, movement restrictions and possible internet blackouts. [14] No clashes had been reported by the cutoff.

Assessment: Disruption risk is highest today and around the 6 Nov Lissu verdict; internet shutdowns would be the leading indicator.

SOMALIA: Survivor says at least 20 soldiers died in the Bay ambush

An officer who survived Monday's ambush near Jameeca told AP he saw "at least 20" fellow soldiers dead; others are still missing. Al-Shabaab says it seized Turkish-supplied armoured vehicles. [15] A Somali outlet says about 2,000 troops in more than 200 vehicles took part in the operation, and analysts call it the army's worst setback since 2023. [16]

Assessment: The first independent eyewitness count suggests heavy government losses, and the push to reopen the Baidoa-Mogadishu road has likely stalled.

NIGERIA: Senate puts Taraba toll at about 80

The Senate passed a motion for more troops and security camps on the Taraba, Plateau and Bauchi borders after the Binari attack, which it said "killed about 80 people", higher than the police figure of 62. [17] *Pre-window onset:* gunmen killed six or seven people in Jos South, Plateau. [18]

Assessment: Tolls remain disputed and Middle Belt violence shows little sign of deterrence.

DRC: More army officers reportedly defect to Kabila's front

A pro-Kigali outlet reports that a FARDC brigade operations deputy and a brigadier general have joined Kabila's FRN, with two more officers to be named. [19] Local officials in Uvira had called FRN claims of advancing nearby false. [20]

Assessment: The defections are unconfirmed; if real, they would strengthen Kabila's political front more than its military position.

EBOLA: No outcome yet from the ministers' meeting; counts conflict

No communiqué from Africa CDC's 28 Oct ministers' meeting was found. SciDev.Net gives 9,552 confirmed DRC cases and more than 4,600 deaths, below other tallies of more than 10,000. [21] Nigeria's NCDC is monitoring 54 contacts after evacuating its only patient and says elections will not be postponed. [22]

Assessment: Spread outside the DRC still looks limited to single clusters, while the DRC epidemic keeps growing.

Collection gap: no Russia-Africa declaration, signed-document list or Putin-Burhan readout was published by the cutoff. Nothing new was found on Mali, Burkina Faso, the Niger-Chad dispute, the Algerian deployment or Ethiopia-Eritrea clashes.

// CENTCOM

ISRAEL: Near-final count gives Netanyahu bloc 53, Eisenkot bloc 48, Arab parties a record 19

With about 90% counted, the Central Elections Committee figures cited by the Times of Israel give Netanyahu's bloc 53 seats (Likud 26), Eisenkot's bloc 48 (Yashar 21, Bennett 12) and Arab-led parties 19. Two smaller parties fell below the threshold. Netanyahu told Ben Gvir and Smotrich "we are staying together", and Eisenkot says he will seek a Zionist government. [23] i24 reports Ra'am at 8 seats and the Joint List at 11. [24] Counting of

430,000-480,000 double-envelope ballots began early Thursday; Hebrew media suggest Shas may lose a seat to Likud. [25]

Assessment: The double-envelope count is likely to shift one or two seats without giving either bloc 61, leaving Herzog's choice and the Arab parties' stance decisive.

ISRAEL: Elections chief asks Shin Bet to examine foreign-funding claims

Central Elections Committee chair Noam Sohlberg asked Shin Bet to investigate "serious suspicions" of foreign funding and electoral bribery, while saying he could not vouch for them, and requested findings within a week. [26] Likud reportedly believes Qatar funded Arab get-out-the-vote groups. [27] A police source said there is "no investigative- or intelligence-based supporting evidence" that the election was stolen. [28]

Assessment: The probe gives Likud grounds to challenge results in Arab localities and could delay certification on 4 Nov, even if nothing is found.

IRAN / US: AP confirms warnings to allies; carrier and Marines building up

AP, citing two diplomats, says US officials told regional allies to prepare for renewed strikes on Iran after the 3 Nov midterms and for Iranian retaliation against energy infrastructure, in a round that could last "several days". The USS Theodore Roosevelt and amphibious ships with about 9,000 personnel were sent late last month. Foreign Minister Araghchi said Iran is "still giving diplomacy a chance", and the UAE urged both sides to avoid full-scale war. [29] The Wall Street Journal adds an extra Patriot battery for Israel. [30] It also reports that Vice President Vance sent a letter to Iran's security council chief; Trump said he did not direct it. [31]

Assessment: The build-up and allied warnings point to strikes being prepared for early November, while the parallel diplomatic signals leave room for a deal.

SAUDI ARABIA: Satellite imagery shows damage at Ras Tanura refinery

Sentinel-2 imagery reviewed by Maritime Executive appears to show the Houthi missile hit a cracking unit at the 550,000 bpd Ras Tanura refinery, and flaring has stopped. Crude loadings appear unaffected, with nine supertankers loading nearby. No Saudi or Aramco statement has been issued. [32]

Assessment: The impact likely falls on refined products such as diesel and jet fuel rather than crude exports.

IRAN / HORMUZ: Guards say three more tankers hit mines

The IRGC says three tankers using an "unauthorized route south of the Strait of Hormuz" hit mines and caught fire in the previous 24 hours. UKMTO separately reported a ship on fire about 9 nm north of Khasab, Oman, with no cause given. [33]

Assessment: If accurate, mining is now hitting several ships a day on the southern bypass route. The mine strikes are not independently confirmed.

YEMEN: Fighting intensifies on several fronts

The Houthi health ministry says Saudi-led strikes on a market in al-Hazm killed 14. Yemen's government says two Houthi missiles hit Aden airport's runway, diverting flights, and the Houthi siege of Taiz is tightening. [34] Iranian state media claim the coalition carried out 101 strikes in 24 hours. [35]

Assessment: Fighting at Aden and near Bab el-Mandeb threatens the Red Sea route Saudi Arabia now relies on to bypass Hormuz.

ENERGY: Brent eases to about $114.10

Brent settled Wednesday at $115.32 and slipped to $114.10 early Thursday as traders reacted to the reported Vance outreach. [31]

Assessment: Diplomacy signals and the threat of post-midterm strikes are pulling prices in opposite directions; mining and Houthi attacks keep the risk to the upside.

KUWAIT / IRAN: Iranian ambassador summoned over death sentences

Kuwait summoned Iran's ambassador after the embassy rejected charges against an Iranian sentenced to death for spying and plotting to assassinate the interior minister, calling the statement "blatant interference". [36]

Assessment: Gulf-Iran friction is widening just as Washington tells Gulf capitals to prepare for retaliation.

PAKISTAN / AFGHANISTAN: Taliban accuse Pakistan of drone strikes at Angoor Adda

The Taliban defence ministry says Pakistan carried out four drone strikes on Barmal district, Paktika, and that Taliban forces retaliated. [37] Pakistan says Taliban mortar fire started the clash, killing one civilian. [38]

Assessment: The clashes are escalating from mortar exchanges to claimed drone strikes, with no ceasefire mechanism in place.

GAZA: Strike near Red Cross field hospital kills three

A strike near a Red Cross field hospital in Rafah killed three and wounded 15, according to Nasser Hospital. Gaza's health ministry says more than 1,550 people have been killed since the October 2025 ceasefire. [34]

Assessment: Low-level violence continues, with attention crowded out by Israel's election and the Iran file.

SYRIA / JORDAN: Border crossing reopens; joint security committee formed

Traffic resumed at the Nasib crossing on Wednesday, and the two foreign ministers agreed a joint security committee after Jordanian strikes killed seven civilians. Damascus still denies the strikes were coordinated. [39]

Assessment: The crisis is easing for now, but the coordination dispute is unresolved.

Collection gap: nothing new was found on Lebanon, Iraqi militias, Central Asia, an Egyptian deployment or an official Saudi statement on Ras Tanura.

// EUCOM

RUSSIA / UKRAINE: Russia claims 1,214 Ukrainian drones downed overnight

Russia's defence ministry says it downed 1,214 drones overnight, and Moscow's mayor said 613 headed for the Moscow region. [40] TASS reports 170 over Kaluga and 42 over Tula, with Vnukovo, Domodedovo and Zhukovsky airports suspended and restrictions at about 18 others. [41] Kyiv Post, citing a Russian Telegram channel, says drones hit a chemical plant in Bashkortostan used in body-armour production. [40] Ukraine has not commented. [42]

Assessment: This appears to be one of the largest Ukrainian attacks on the Moscow region this year, timed to the Russia-Africa summit. Russian figures are unverified.

UKRAINE: Russia launches 112 drones; Kharkiv hit

Ukraine's Air Force says Russia launched 112 drones overnight and 97 were downed, with hits at seven locations. [43] Kharkiv's mayor reported damage to an educational building. [42] Ukrainian intelligence says Russia is building a drone launch site near Millerovo that could eventually support up to 100 launches a day. [44]

Assessment: Medium-sized Russian raids continue outside the Kherson truce zone.

UKRAINE: Oleshky ceasefire holds for 54 hours; aid cargo planned for 30 Oct

Ukraine's ombudsman reports no violations after 54 hours; demining of access routes is under way and an aid cargo is planned for 30 Oct. [45] A Melania Trump adviser says Putin named her Russia's "exclusive intermediary" in a formal letter and that the deal was signed in Belarus. [46] Estimates of residents remaining conflict, from 1,700-2,000 to up to 6,000. [47]

Assessment: The truce is holding. The test comes with the first convoys and evacuations and where residents are moved.

UKRAINE / US / RUSSIA: Zelensky expects Abu Dhabi talks between 6 and 10 Nov

Zelensky said he hopes for three-way talks between 6 and 10 Nov and expects US confirmation after the midterms; the Kremlin has not confirmed. [48] In a call with Trump, Erdoğan offered Türkiye's support for renewed diplomacy, and the two discussed Hormuz and Yemen. [49]

Assessment: Technical talks first, with any leaders' summit later, remains the likeliest path.

GERMANY / ROMANIA: Two Belarusians held over Russia-linked sabotage plot

Munich prosecutors say two Belarusians in custody since 7 Oct planned arson in the Nuremberg area on behalf of a foreign state. [50] Romanian investigators are examining the pair over the Brașov arson and seeking extradition. [51]

Assessment: The evidence for a single Russia-directed network operating across several countries is getting stronger.

SERBIA: Embassy attacker named in media as 17-year-old

Serbian daily Novosti, cited by BNO News, named the Belgrade embassy attacker as a 17-year-old previously known for links to Islamic State ideology; the name is not officially confirmed. [52] The Student List is expected to win about 140 of 250 seats, but mandates will not be verified for at least a month. [53]

Assessment: The outgoing government keeps control of the security services during an awkward transition, while the terror alert stays raised.

SPAIN: High-speed train collision near Toledo kills at least 68

Pre-window onset: a RENFE train hit a stopped Iryo train near Urda at 0853 local on 28 Oct, killing at least 68 and injuring more than 80. [54] The transport minister said a computer fault disabled a safety system and central control then ordered the RENFE train to proceed, which he called "inexplicable". [55]

Assessment: This is a major civil disaster. Nothing in the reporting suggests sabotage, but the cause of the computer fault is the open question.

MOLDOVA: Cyberattacks exposed data on about 750,000 people

An opposition party is seeking a parliamentary inquiry into cyberattacks on government systems that exposed ID, pension and financial data on about 750,000 people. No attribution has been made. [56]

Assessment: A breach of this size in a state facing Russian hybrid pressure could feed influence operations.

Collection gap: the latest ISW assessment did not load, and no confirmed front-line changes were found. Nothing new was found on a NATO airspace incident, Serbian certification, Georgia, or France beyond previews of the 31 Oct protests.

// INDOPACOM

NORTH KOREA: About 10 to 12 short-range ballistic missiles fired from Wonsan

South Korea's Joint Chiefs said North Korea fired short-range ballistic missiles from the Wonsan area at about 1230 local time, its first ballistic launch since 12 Oct. [57][58] Yonhap later put the number at "about a dozen" with a range of about 250 km, and said they are believed to be KN-25 600mm rockets. Seoul said the launch "directly violates" UN resolutions; Japan said it fell outside its EEZ. [59]

Assessment: A salvo about a week after Seoul's offer of border talks looks like a rejection of that offer, adding pressure before the 31 Oct loudspeaker deadline.

NORTH KOREA: North appears to test border loudspeakers

Residents of border villages heard music, wails and animal cries from North Korean speakers for four to five hours from 0600 on 29 Oct, Yonhap reports. [60] Seoul is split: the Defence Ministry says it will respond proportionately, while the unification minister opposes resuming South Korean broadcasts. [61]

Assessment: If confirmed, Pyongyang is ahead of its own deadline. Whether Seoul answers with its own broadcasts is now the main escalation question.

PHILIPPINES / CHINA / US: Public row over China's ADMM-Plus downgrade

China's defence ministry said a "self-serving" Philippine politician put "obstacles" in the way of its attendance and claimed many ASEAN states objected; Defence Secretary Teodoro replied, "It is China's position; it is not ASEAN's position." [62][63] China's attaché was received by an undersecretary, not Teodoro. [64] Teodoro set international law and maritime security as priorities, and no ADMM-Plus declaration was reported. [65] Hegseth proposed a multi-year US-ASEAN defence framework starting with Singapore, the 2027 chair. [66] Global Times blamed Manila and said Hegseth and Koizumi agreed on "effective denial defense" in the first island chain. [67]

Assessment: The attendance dispute has become an open China-Philippines quarrel as the chair passes to Singapore.

TAIWAN: Taipei says 53 Chinese ships deployed from Japan to the Philippines

Taiwan's National Security Council chief posted a map showing 53 Chinese naval and official ships, 34 of them warships, spread from southern Japan to east of the Philippines, including the Liaoning carrier group. He called the threat "obvious". [68]

Assessment: A deployment across three theatres during plenum and ASEAN week fits a pattern of signalling without a named exercise.

CHINA: Fifth plenum closes today; no communiqué yet

Reuters reported before the window that the plenum was expected to ratify the expulsions of Politburo members Zhang Youxia and Ma Xingrui, with five of seven 2022 Central Military Commission members already removed. [69] No communiqué had been published by the cutoff.

Assessment: The communiqué will likely come after the window; any appointment to replace Zhang as CMC vice-chair is the item to watch.

MYANMAR: ASEAN envoy's aid mission under way; no Suu Kyi meeting confirmed

Envoy Ma. Theresa Lazaro began her mission in Taunggyi, launching aid to more than 11,000 households. [70] The Philippine foreign ministry gave "no details" on any meeting with Aung San Suu Kyi. [71] DVB reported before the window that the junta had refused repeated requests for such a meeting. [72]

Assessment: The visit so far is a humanitarian-access exercise with no political breakthrough.

AUSTRALIA: Inquiry finds systemic failures in SAS command in Afghanistan

The published summary of a long-secret inquiry found an "inversion of authority", an "abandonment of curiosity" among senior leaders and unusual enemy-killed figures that headquarters did not act on. The full report will not be released. [73]

Assessment: The findings spread responsibility up the chain of command and will feed into war-crimes prosecutions already under way.

INDONESIA: Jakarta protest over corruption and haze

Hundreds protested in Jakarta and other cities over corruption and the wildfire response, with about 14,000 police deployed; fires have burned more than 1.9 million hectares this year. Singapore's foreign minister met Prabowo the same day. [74]

Assessment: The haze has become a domestic legitimacy problem for Prabowo and a source of strain with Singapore.

SOLOMON ISLANDS: Prime Minister Wale flown to Australia for urgent treatment

Prime Minister Matthew Wale was flown to Australia for urgent medical treatment, with no details given. [75] The opposition leader issued get-well wishes. [76]

Assessment: A long absence would raise succession questions in a government Beijing and Canberra both court.

INDIA / PAKISTAN: New Delhi says its Pakistan policy is unchanged

India's foreign ministry said its post-Pahalgam policy "remains in place" after inviting a Pakistani minister to an SCO forum in New Delhi, saying all members were invited as usual. [77]

Assessment: Contact remains limited to multilateral settings.

Collection gap: no plenum communiqué, Taiwan defence ministry daily count, ADMM-Plus outcome document or KCNA account of the launch was found. Several Philippine, Japanese and Taiwanese sites did not load.

// NORTHCOM

UNITED STATES: Judge Carter rejects DOJ bid to set aside California ballots

Judge David Carter denied DOJ's request to stop processing the ballots of up to 20,000 people it says are likely noncitizens, writing, "Once a vote is segregated, lasting harm has occurred." He appointed no special master, reversing his earlier inclination. More than 3.7 million Californians have already voted. DOJ says it will appeal immediately. [78] A Ninth Circuit panel had dismissed DOJ's first appeal 2-1 on 26 Oct. [79]

Assessment: A reversal before 3 Nov is unlikely; an emergency application to the Supreme Court is DOJ's likely next step.

UNITED STATES: FEC filing system restored after about 41 hours

The FEC brought its e-filing system back on Wednesday night after nearly 41 hours offline following an attempted breach; the cause has not been disclosed. During the outage super PACs could not file late-spending reports. [80]

Assessment: The disclosure backlog should clear before the vote; attribution remains open.

UNITED STATES: DOJ says FBI and ICE staff will not serve as poll monitors

In a court filing, DOJ said FBI and ICE personnel will not serve as election monitors; Bureau of Prisons, ATF and DEA staff will, unarmed. The filing date is uncertain because the page's timestamps conflict with its text. [81]

Assessment: This narrows one intimidation concern but keeps federal law-enforcement staff in the monitor pool, so litigation will likely continue.

MEXICO: Navy kills US-indicted Guasave Cartel deputy

The navy says a 26 Oct clash in Sinaloa left two dead who "may correspond to" Jesús "Chuy" González Peñuelas, wanted by the US with a $5 million reward, and his uncle; the security minister said González was one of them. [82] Federal forces also arrested a CJNG plaza boss in Oaxaca. [83]

Assessment: High-value takedowns of US-indicted targets support Mexico's case that cooperation works, but risk succession violence in northern Sinaloa.

MEXICO / US: Ambassador says terrorist designation is about finance, not strikes

US Ambassador Ronald Johnson said the cartel terrorist designation is meant to unlock "financial tools, economic sanctions", rejected the idea that it enables strikes in Mexico, and called security cooperation one of its best moments. [84]

Assessment: This is the clearest US official reassurance on unilateral action in recent weeks, though it does not bind the White House.

EAST PACIFIC: Vance holds at 40 mph, post-tropical later today

NHC's 0900Z advisory places Vance about 300 miles west-northwest of Manzanillo with 40 mph winds and no watches or warnings; it is forecast to become post-tropical late today. [85] No Atlantic formation is expected over the next seven days. [86]

Assessment: Vance poses a minimal threat to land.

CANADA: Ottawa to brief on new national security measures

The Privy Council Office scheduled an embargoed briefing on 29 Oct on "upcoming Government of Canada national security measures", embargoed until 1400Z. [87] Carney said Canada is "not in that position right now" to reach a trade deal before the midterms. [88] A senior adviser said last week a new national security strategy was imminent. [89]

Assessment: The measures likely relate to the long-awaited strategy; content will come after the window.

UNITED STATES: Big Bend wall case awaits challengers' response

Challengers' response to the government's Supreme Court emergency application to lift the Big Bend wall injunction is due at 1600 ET on 29 Oct; the injunction remains in force. [90]

Assessment: A ruling or administrative stay could come any time after today's filing.

Collection gap: no domestic security incident, attack on election infrastructure or new Guard activation was found in the window.

// SOUTHCOM

CUBA / UN: Embargo condemned again, but by its narrowest margin since 1995

The General Assembly adopted Cuba's resolution 130-17 with 25 abstentions, against 165-7-12 last year. [91] Euronews calls it the lowest support since 1995; Colombia, Ecuador, Costa Rica and Guatemala are among those reported voting no for the first time, and Germany and Italy abstained. Ambassador Waltz welcomed the shift, while Cuba's foreign minister said the US was "once again isolated". [92] A diaspora outlet's country lists do not match its own totals. [93] The US Embassy in Havana closed in-person services during a demonstration outside it. [94]

Assessment: US pressure has substantially eroded Latin American and European support for Havana.

BRAZIL / US: Flávio Bolsonaro lands in Miami on a US visa

Flávio Bolsonaro and his family landed in Miami on 28 Oct after crossing into Argentina and flying via Ecuador; AP says the administration granted the promised visas. Lula called it "shameful"; Trump called the family "fine people". [95] Brasília is urging caution and treating the case as judicial. [96] Reports conflict on which passport he used and whether Argentina recorded his entry. [97]

Assessment: Brasília is avoiding a confrontation for now; any Supreme Court arrest warrant and extradition request would test relations quickly.

HAITI: Elections pushed to July 2027; El Salvador pledges more than 2,000 troops

Haiti's electoral council moved the first round from 13 Dec 2026 to 18 Jul 2027. [98] El Salvador pledged more than 2,000 troops to search for four missing Salvadorans and confront gangs, up from the roughly 1,000 reported this week; it is unclear whether they will serve under the Gang Suppression Force. [99]

Assessment: A large national contingent partly outside the UN-backed force, combined with an indefinite transition, raises the risk of escalation and command friction.

VENEZUELA: Machado tours quake-hit La Guaira before first press conference

Machado toured La Guaira on 28 Oct, and her first press conference since returning is set for 29 Oct. [100] Her team says she is open to talks with acting President Rodríguez. [101]

Assessment: Expect her to demand an election timetable and a seat in the US-brokered talks.

COLOMBIA: Sixth airstrike hits Clan del Golfo in Chocó

The government bombed a Clan del Golfo structure in Chocó, the sixth strike since President De La Espriella took office, with a preliminary toll of six killed and one captured. [102][103]

Assessment: Bogotá is widening its air campaign beyond the ELN; scrutiny of civilian casualties is likely to grow.

ECUADOR: Unions and Indigenous groups begin protest series in Quito

Unions and Indigenous organisations called a march in Quito for 29 Oct, the first of several dates before the 29 Nov local elections, against what they call a "police state". [104]

Assessment: Turnout will test the opposition's strength a month before the vote.

PERU: Fujimori visits Bukele; "PM replacement" was a temporary handover

President Keiko Fujimori arrived in El Salvador for a four-day visit including the CECOT mega-prison. [105] A resolution makes PM Galarreta acting head of the presidency during her trips, which explains yesterday's reported replacement rumour. [106]

Assessment: The visit signals intent to adopt Bukele-style security policies; there is no sign of a cabinet crisis.

Collection gap: the UN vote annex could not be retrieved, so country lists are unverified. Machado's and Flávio Bolsonaro's press conferences fall after the window. No new ELN reporting was found.

// WATCH ITEMS (NEXT 72 HOURS)

- Israel's double-envelope result and the Shin Bet funding inquiry. [25][26]
- US force movements and Iranian moves before the 3 Nov midterms. [29]
- More tanker mine strikes near Hormuz and Houthi attacks on Aden and Saudi refineries. [33][34]
- Russia-Africa outcome documents and the Putin-Burhan readout. [6]
- Oleshky's first aid convoy and evacuations (30 Oct). [45]
- North Korea's loudspeakers before 31 Oct and the CCP plenum communiqué. [60][69]
- DOJ's appeal on California ballots and Supreme Court action on Big Bend. [78][90]
- Machado's press conference and any Brazilian move against Flávio Bolsonaro. [100][96]
- Tanzania's commemorations today and the 6 Nov Lissu verdict. [13]

// SOURCE SUMMARY STATEMENT

This report draws on 106 open-source items published or updated between 23 and 29 October 2026. They include international wire services (AP, AFP, Reuters, EFE, Yonhap, PTI) carried by Yahoo News, CP24, WSLS, Spectrum News, ThePrint, Dawn, Arab News, TimesLIVE, Malay Mail, Taipei Times and others; US and international outlets (CBS News, Al Jazeera, Euronews, ABC News Australia, Christian Science Monitor, Times of Israel, Kyiv Independent, Kyiv Post, The Moscow Times); regional press (The National, The New Arab, Express Tribune, Afghanistan International, Radio Tamazuj, Radio Dabanga, ThisDay, The Sun, Somali Guardian, La Presse Africaine, LB.ua, UNN, MoldovaLive, Philstar, Daily Tribune, Manila Times, Korea JoongAng Daily, SBS, The Tribune, Infobae, El Financiero, Metrópoles, Gazeta do Povo, El Tiempo, El Espectador, Efecto Cocuyo, RPP); specialist and official sources (National Hurricane Center, UN News, US embassies, the Government of Canada, Maritime Executive, World Nuclear News). TASS, Global Times, Fana, Bernama and UNITED24 are state or state-linked media; Al Jazeera, The National and The New Arab are Gulf state-funded or state-owned; A News is a pro-government Turkish outlet; Taarifa Rwanda is aligned with Kigali. Several items rest on unverified claims by parties to conflicts (Russian drone counts, IRGC mine claims, Houthi casualty figures, Taliban and Pakistani border claims). The Wall Street Journal's reporting is known only from secondary outlets. Lower-reliability sources (CiberCuba, Newsquawk/IRNA, JFeed, When In Your State) are flagged and used only for narrow points. Rio Times and Wisevoter pages were excluded as automated content. ISW, the Taiwan defence ministry, the UN vote annex and several Philippine and Japanese sites did not load. Coverage gaps include the Sahel, Lebanon, Japan and the CCP plenum outcome.

// ENDNOTES (ICD 206)

All sources accessed 29 October 2026. All sources are publicly available reporting.

AFRICOM

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